

Through the balanced exercising of negative and positive power, a state can produce and implement the desired foreign policy by gaining the ability to influence and adjust other states' interests to align with their own interests.

The process of constructing foreign policy includes the utilization of diplomatic, informational, military, and economic means as instruments of power. Power conducted through diplomatic channels means that the state may formally or informally interact with other state or non-state actors to represent, negotiating, and implement foreign policy. As stated in Chapter Four of the *National Security Strategy Primer*, this interaction is used to gain insight into the opposing actors' interests and what motivates them which allows the US to both initiate policies as well as block actions that would have gone against US foreign policy's goals. Another tool of power is the ability to perceive, inform, and manipulate information through intelligence, public diplomacy, cyber or psychological operations, and propaganda. This tool has the capability to exploit the vulnerabilities of foreign actors and alter them to better suit the goals of the US. While the power of the military may be known for its tendency to impart physical force, the threat of force by military actions can be used to elicit a desired reaction, leading to the desired foreign policy. No physical violence is required to lead to the preferred foreign policy. Lastly, economics can be used as a tool of power through assistance, trade, and finance to apply pressure by either constraining or stimulating economic prosperity. The power of all of these tools is both positive and negative, as these tactics can be used as a constructive way to implement foreign policy as well as a way to maneuver foreign actors through indirect manipulations. In Chapter Three of the *Politics of United States Foreign Policy*, James M. Scott and Jerel A. Rosati explain that negative power is the ability to block other actors from doing something that is unbeneficial to one's interests and positive power is the ability to actively implement, initiate something to make things happen.

Through the application of these tools, a government can increase its status within the international community which translates into having more control over the construction of foreign politics. Gaining momentum and status is a highly useful side effect of possessing power as it increases the control one has over the process of policy making. The United States of America exemplifies this phenomenon through its ability to have control over foreign policymaking through the hegemonic power it possesses. As Professor Musgraves stated in the lecture from February 2nd that while the US enjoyed its hegemonic power it shaped the world through militaristic, economic, diplomatic and informational tools. However as Scott and Rosati also emphasize in the "Politics and Patterns" section of *Politics of United States Foreign Policy*, as America's power is waning, its influences, abilities and control within the international community and policymaking has decreased, which can be seen post-Cold War.

There are scholars and others who suggest that negative power should be relied on during the making of foreign policy. The argument is based on the idea that negative power is a pragmatic tool to further a government's interests. People use the proliferation of nuclear weapons as an example of successful negative power being utilized in international affairs. As Scott Sagan explains in "The Perils of Proliferation: Organization Theory, Deterrence Theory, and the Spread of Nuclear Weapons" many view nuclear weapon proliferation as a foreign policy that stabilizes the international community. Proponents of nuclear proliferation employ the expected utility assumption of rational deterrence theory to suggest that through the expansion of nuclear weapons to all states, it will act as a deterrence and block any invasive foreign policies or actions. However, the confidence in having almost all states in possession of nuclear weapons is flawed for numerous reasons. Sagan lists numerous requirements that must be met in order for

nuclear proliferation as a negative power to be a sustainable tool in foreign policy. Preventative war must not occur while some actors are still assembling their arsenal. States involved must be at equal levels of invulnerability. There must be no possibilities of accidental or unauthorized use of the nuclear arsenals. However, all three of these reasons have been historically proven wrong. Throughout the Cold War there were numerous instances where flawed intelligence almost led to the accidental usage of nuclear weapons, and there has never been the assurance between states that there is an equal amount of nuclear weapons in their respective arsenals as well as in vulnerabilities. The power behind nuclear proliferation does not sustainably deter or stabilize the international community. The addition of nuclear weapons increases the risk of nuclear war, as the successfulness of deterrence depends on the actors involved and their interests.

A state is able to control the foreign policymaking process through the balanced use of negative and positive power to influence other actors. This is essential for successful policy implementation since power allows for cohesion in an otherwise crowded environment of different actors with different interests.